ART ▼

Welcome to Moominvalley

AN IMMERSIVE EXHIBIT AT **DELHI'S KNMA CELEBRATES 80 YEARS** OF THE MUCH-LOVED *MOOMINS*



In her book *Comet in Moominland*, the beloved Finnish writer, artist and illustrator Tove Jansson (1914-2001) wrote, "You must go on a long journey before you can really find out how wonderful home is". This sentiment, one of openness to adventure and progress, yet cherishing all that we already have, marks the series of *Moomin* books that Jansson was best known for, featuring the eponymous creatures—round and white, with big snouts and bigger hearts, living together in harmony at 'Moominvalley'. A small slice of Moominvalley is currently available to Delhi residents at Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA), Saket, at the immersive exhibition *Moomin 80—The Door is Always Open*, presented in collaboration with the Embassy of Finland. The exhibition marks 80 years since the Moomins were first seen in print.



THE EPONYMOUS CHARACTERS OF THE BOOK SERIES ARE ROUND, HAVE BIG SNOUTS AND BIGGER HEARTS—INSPIRING KINDNESS IN CHILDREN

Adorned with large cutouts of the Moomins, the exhibition's core space is a child-friendly zone filled with the Moomin books, comics, colouring sheets and so on. For grown-up admirers of Jansson's work there's a section on her personal and professional journey. The name of the exhibition 'the door is always open' communicates values of tolerance, kindness and mutual understanding, qualities that are reinforced by these books, so much so that in the wider world, the Moomins are seen as a kind of metonym for Finnish cultural values.

If you are feeling nostalgic about simpler times, head down to KNMA and let the Moomins take you on a guided trip through your own childhood. ■

—Aditya Mani Jha

The exhibition is on till Jan. 15

The Listicle

What's hot and happening in the world of art this month

DOHA/ MODERN MASTER



Lawh Wa Qalam, a museum dedicated to the works of M.F. Husain, has opened in Doha, Qatar, in a building based on a concept sketch by the master himself. The works on display trace Husain's artistic journey from the 1950s until his death in Qatar in 2011 and include several previously unseen pieces.

Mumbai/ Into the Past

A new gallery at the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya—called 'Networks of the Past: A Study Gallery of India and the Ancient World'—opens with over 300 archaeological objects from 15 museums across India and the world.



HYDERABAD/ VERSATILE GENIUS



A landmark exhibition at Srishti Art Gallery—*Celebrating Dashrath Patel*—brings together a rare collection of the early paintings of the late artist curated by Sadanand Menon, a long-time collaborator. *On view till Feb. 7.*

NEW DELHI / CROSS CURRENTS

Indian Interior, an exhibition presented by La Biennale di Venezia in collaboration with KNMA, and hosted at Bikaner House, brings together a selection of thought-provoking artworks by Indian artists, marking the 700th anniversary of Marco Polo's death. *On view till Dec. 28.*

